

PSYCHEDELICARE.EU IMPACT REPORT

The story of Europe's first citizen initiative for psychedelic care, driven by volunteers, carried in 20 countries, and leaving a movement in its wake.

January 2025 – January 2026

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Part of the Coordination Board in Psychedelic Science, Denver



Psychedelic Conference, Zagreb

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LET'S CARE TOGETHER!



AITÄH!

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PSYCHEDELICARE.EU



Launch event in Estonia

01 — ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

A special thanks to the ones who made it possible.

As the European Citizens' Initiative organized by PsychedeliCare came to an end on 14 January 2026, we would like to express our deepest gratefulness to all the volunteers from Ireland to Greece, from Portugal to Estonia, who made this initiative possible and for their impressive engagement throughout this year of campaigning.

Such a citizen initiative and mobilization, the first of its kind in Europe, wouldn't have been possible without the continuous support of our 50+ partner organizations. They played a pivotal role in disseminating our initiative, in almost all EU languages and Member States, and beyond.

We additionally would like to express our gratitude to our funders and donors, who helped us bring our ideas to life and make a real impact across Europe.

02 — A WORD FROM THE FOUNDER

Why we started.

The European Citizens' Initiative was born from a simple question I had : why citizens living in Switzerland, only two hours away from my hometown – Strasbourg – could enjoy the benefits of scientific research through the legal access of psychedelic therapies, when French citizens could not? The need for better mental health treatments does not stop at borders.

So together with citizens sharing the same belief, we decided to roll up our sleeves and prepare and launch a campaign to get the European Union to take action. The goal was that every European citizen, should ever they need it, could have access to these innovative treatments.

During one year, we campaigned to gather statements of support to our initiative and it was truly wonderful to see the dedication of the volunteers involved – for many of whom it was their first experience of activism – and the energy put into it.

It turned out to be a fantastic, albeit challenging, experience and quite the human adventure.

Even though we did not manage to collect the necessary signatures to trigger a formal response from the EU institutions, we created new places of discussion, debate and information, forged new connections and alliances (sometimes unexpected) and brought people from all over Europe closer together.

A huge thanks to all who participated in this journey. And now, thanks to this citizen mobilization, we can prepare for the future together.

Let's care together!

Théo Giubilei, Founder



Théo Giubilei speaking at New Eleusis Symposium, Greece

03 — THE INITIATIVE AT A GLANCE

One year.
27 countries.
One objective.

74,016

signatures in the 27 Member States

6.6M+

views on social media

500+

volunteers across 20 countries

50+

Partners across 18 countries

130

Events (co-)organized

70+

Media mentions

13

Newsletters sent, 2,000+ readers



To bring the European Union to act, so that all Europeans could have access to psychedelic therapies if needed, we as citizens had a tool at our disposal capable of making a difference: the European Citizens' Initiative.

Introduced in 2012 as a participatory democratic tool, citizens who want the European Union to take up and act on an issue can build and run a campaign, collect statements of support, and bring the topic before the institutions.

In short, there is one year to collect one million signatures across Europe. That was the challenge we set ourselves, with limited resources but ambitious ideas.



European Parliament Lauch Event, Brussels

04 — A PAN-EUROPEAN MOBILIZATION

16 national teams. One shared mission.

Over the course of this year-long campaign, no fewer than 16 national teams, formed before or during the initiative, carried PsychedeliCare across Europe. These national teams were made up of citizens ready to promote the campaign in their own countries, translate the messages and materials prepared by the European coordination team, and work independently while maintaining close contact with the other national and European teams.

But behind the numbers are citizens who chose to get involved: artists, researchers, healthcare professionals, psychiatrists, communication experts, students, lawyers, patients.

All of them believed it was time for the European Union and its Member States to act, and saw in PsychedeliCare a way to carry their ideas forward, alongside other concerned citizens and organisations fighting for the same cause.

"The greatest treasure was the friends we found along the way."

Mario, coordinator, Croatia

04 — A PAN-EUROPEAN MOBILIZATION

The campaign in action.

For a year and a half before the official launch, the groundwork was being laid: building national teams, forging partnerships, and growing a European network one conversation at a time.

When the campaign officially opened on 14 January 2025, 7,000 signatures were collected across all 27 Member States on the very first day, a promising start that reflected the energy built up during that preparatory phase.

For many, PsychedeliCare represented a first experience of activism. This tells us something profound: many citizens are mobilising in response to the perceived slowness of European and national policies on psychedelic therapies, in light of the growing body of scientific evidence and the more progressive approaches being pursued in other parts of the world.

And the campaign unfolded amidst real legislative movement across Europe. During the year, the Czech Republic approved psilocybin therapies for treatment-resistant depression by a wide parliamentary majority and Germany opened the door to compassionate use. The conversation PsychedeliCare was part of was already underway.

Denmark

Folkemødet panel with a Member of Parliament, packed tent

France

Online launch: 600 registrants

Luxembourg

Psychedelic therapies discussed in the Parliament, with a response from the Health minister

Estonia

Launch seminar with 200 participants

Slovenia

Collaboration opened with Ljubljana Oncology Institute

Poland

Intense social media activities, +1,6M views during the campaign



Sign banner on a boat in Copenhagen

A concrete illustration of this was the European launch event, held at the European Parliament on 6 February 2025. Bringing together around 200 participants in person from over 20 European countries, 4 Members of the European Parliament from both left and right, alongside researcher and patient panellists, the event brought the subject to the heart of the European institutions.

400+ people were part of national coordination groups across the continent, and the diversity of approaches reflected the diversity of contexts: a street signature collection in Vienna and Brussels, a panel discussion at Denmark's Democracy Festival with a member of parliament to a packed tent, a launch seminar in Estonia that drew 200 participants, a national online launch event in France with 600 registered attendees.

In total, across 20 countries, our teams organised or co-organised not less than 130 events and participated in 45 external conferences and festivals, from academic symposia to music festivals, from university campuses and film screenings to public squares.

04 — A PAN-EUROPEAN MOBILIZATION

Each team carried the campaign in its own language and culture, adapting it to its national context, because talking about mental health and psychedelic substances in Portugal or Poland does not carry the same implications.

What united them was a shared sense of urgency, and the friendships and alliances built along the way. As the coordinator from Croatia, Mario put it: "The greatest treasure was the friends we found along the way."

In Slovenia, the campaign opened unexpected doors, including the beginnings of a collaboration with the Ljubljana Oncology Institute on the use of psychedelics for end-of-life anxiety. Across all 16 countries, the campaign left behind something that no signature count can fully capture: a network of people who now know each other, and who are ready to keep going.



Campaigning pictures in several countries: Estonia, Iceland, USA, France, Slovenia, Spain, Portugal, Italy

05 — WHY IT MATTERS

This citizen mobilisation is grounded in a very concrete reality: millions of people across Europe live with mental health conditions, and for many, existing treatments simply do not work. Behind the numbers are years of personal suffering and it is these stories that PsychedeliCare wanted to bring to light, giving a voice to those most directly affected.

Over the course of the campaign, we recorded the in-depth testimonies of three citizens from across Europe.

These are three stories among millions. They are the reasons behind our campaign and the reason why we will keep going.

MATHIAS

**Treatment resistant depression,
Belgium**

Shared his story on World Mental Health Day. His testimony on Belgian national TV reached 250,000 people.

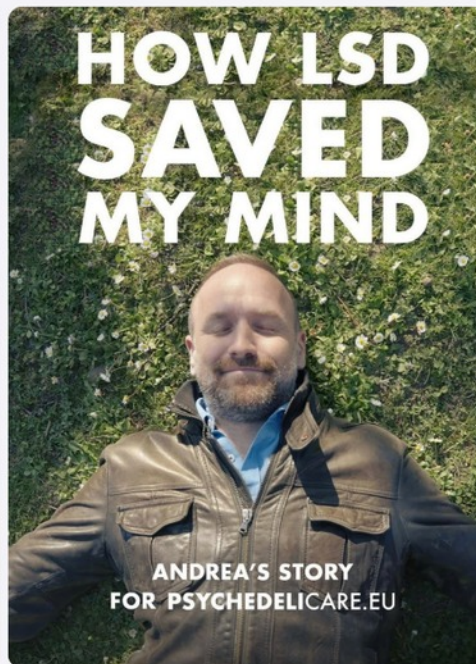


"I was in my third episode of depression, very intense... My life changed. There was a clear before and after."

ANDREA

**Cancer & end-of-life anxiety,
Switzerland**

LSD-assisted psychotherapy within Switzerland's limited medical programme.



"The most difficult idea for me was to leave my children orphans. Now, mentally I feel extremely well — I'm balanced."

NICOLAS

**Cluster headaches,
France**

About 600,000 Europeans live with cluster headaches, sometimes called the 'suicide headache.'



"It stopped the worst thing that was in my life. Almost every time, I have a moment of emotion when I think back to that."

06 — BUILDING A COALITION

50+ organisations. 18+ countries. One coalition.

Driven by engaged citizens, this initiative would not have achieved such reach without the support of more than 50 partner organisations across Europe, a coalition that is, in itself, a first of its kind: not only in size, but in its diversity.

Spanning over 18 countries, it brought together organisations working across psychedelic research and education, harm reduction, scientific freedom, European democracy, patients' rights, and mental health innovation.

Public figures, too, chose to stand with PsychedeliCare, something far from self-evident when psychedelics are involved. Marco Cappato (former MEP, Eumans) and MEP Tilly Metz lent their public support. The Pirate Party officially endorsed the initiative.

From the academic community: Michael Pollan, Paul Stamets, Rick Doblin, Robin Carhart-Harris, and historian Zoë Dubus added credibility and visibility to this grassroots movement.



Marco Cappato, Italian politician at the Parliament's launch event

Not every door opened. Some figures and organisations were not yet ready to associate their name publicly with the topic. But many of those conversations are ongoing and some doors that were firmly closed a year ago are beginning to open.



Folkemødet panel with a Member of Parliament, Denmark

06 — BUILDING A COALITION

They supported
our mission.



07 — ADVOCACY & POLITICAL IMPACT

Three requests. One clear path.

Psychedelic therapies have rarely been the subject of organised advocacy, certainly not at this scale in Europe. In this sense, PsychedeliCare broke new ground.

The conversation around psychedelic therapies is too often confined to scientific circles. Yet if these treatments are ever to become widely accessible, equitably, affordably, safely, and without discrimination, political recognition must come first. That is what we set out to build.

From the outset, the initiative was grounded in three concrete requests to the European Commission, developed as early as late 2023 by the initiative's first partners and volunteers, and formally acknowledged by the Commission in October 2024 as falling within its competence:

01

Creation of European Standards

Bringing together professionals, patients and Member States representatives to agree on standardised guidelines for the safe use of psychedelics in therapeutic settings.

02

Increased EU Research Funding

Boosting European investment in psychedelic therapy research and protecting the freedom to conduct it.

03

A Unified International Stance

Coordinating EU Member States around a common position on the legal classification of psychedelics internationally.



Théo Giubilei and Marco Cappato, European Parliament

Political momentum built across Europe:

The political interest generated by the campaign was real and cross-partisan. The European launch event at the European Parliament on 6 February 2025 brought together MEPs from both left and right.

The topic was debated in the Luxembourg Parliament for the first time in the country's history. Discussions were initiated with a French senator, Irish official representatives, a Belgian Socialist MP who has confirmed her intention to follow up in the Belgian Parliament, the Pirate Party endorsed the initiative...

This is not yet enough to reach the mainstream. But the direction is clear, and as one volunteer put it, the doors that were firmly closed a year ago are beginning to open. Efforts that need to be continued.

08 — COMMUNICATION & VISIBILITY

Breaking through the bubble.

Psychedelic-assisted therapies have been gaining ground in specialist media for several years, and are increasingly finding their way into mainstream coverage. The same is true on social media, where the topic is slowly becoming part of broader public conversations.

Yet this reality remains uneven across Europe. In many countries, the subject is still largely unknown or **stigmatized**, and even where it is beginning to enter public discourse, its reach remains limited. The therapeutic potential of psychedelics is still largely **confined to an informed bubble**, and breaking through to wider audiences remains one of the central challenges of this movement.

Throughout the campaign, PsychedeliCare actively contributed to changing this, working to bring these conversations **into the mainstream** and make the case for innovative therapies to audiences who had never encountered them before.

6.6M+

views across social media
Instagram · Facebook · LinkedIn

70+ media mentions across 10 countries

39+

Online

11

Print

11

Radio

7

TV

Coverage in: Politico Europe · Le Monde · France Inter · France 24 · RTBF · Der Standard · ORF · Público · Expresso



Al via l'iniziativa europea sugli psichedelici

di Marco Perleuca

L'iniziativa, promossa da oltre 30 organizzazioni (in Italia l'Associazione Luca Coscioni, la Società medicina psichedelica SIMEPsi e MAPS Italia) oltre a ricercatori, terapisti, pazienti, presenti in 17 paesi dell'Ue, chiede tre cose:

P INVESTIGAZIONE CIENTIFICA

Organizações lançam campanha para doentes acederem a terapias com psicadélicos na UE

POLITICO

Europe's psychedelics petition push

By GREGORY SVIRNOVSKIY and ERIN SCHUMAKER | 01/24/2025 02:00 PM EST



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EL SALTO

PSICOACTIVOS · Salud mental · Actualidad

PsychedeliCare, una campaña ciudadana para regular las terapias psicodélicas en Europa

Pretenden recoger un millón de firmas para llevar el debate sobre los tratamientos de salud mental con estas sustancias a

PsychedeliCare Launches First European Citizens' Initiative Demanding Political Action on Psychedelic-Assisted Therapies

From 14 January 2025, the PsychedeliCare European Citizens' Initiative (ECI) has 12 months to gather one million signatures in support of its request that the European Commission take meaningful action to fund, standardise and reschedule psychedelics for medical use.

PSYCHEDELIC ALPHA

Analysis

08 — COMMUNICATION & VISIBILITY

The campaign sustained a newsletter throughout the year, **sending 13 editions** to over 2,500 subscribers.

On social media, PsychedeliCare's content produced by European and national communication teams and amplified through partnerships with content creators, cumulate **+6,6 million views**.

Three examples illustrate the scale of what was achieved.



c'est qu'une initiative



66,7 K



1447



5494



42,1 K

...



1.6M

views in France alone

Partnership with Vivre Moins Con
40,000+ shares, a record for this
type of content in Europe

08 — COMMUNICATION & VISIBILITY

In France, a video produced in partnership with Vivre Moins Con, a creator known for tackling political, social and environmental issues, was viewed over 1.6 million times and shared more than 40,000 times.

In Belgium, where information on psychedelic therapies remains scarce, a collaboration with Félicien Bogaerts, former journalist and content creator, generated 304,000 views, over 14,000 likes, and 6,000 shares.

In Poland, where the topic remains heavily stigmatised, the national team achieved remarkable reach through consistent, high-quality educational content and the support of influencer Mestoslaw, totalling 1.6 million views over the course of the campaign.



PsychedeliCare's Instagram page now has over 17,600 followers, making PsychedeliCare one of the most visible players on social media in the field of psychedelic therapies in Europe.

These figures reflect something beyond communication strategy. They are the result of volunteers who made an unprecedented effort to confront stigma and bring the conversation about psychedelic therapies to audiences who had never engaged with it before.

09 — CHALLENGES & LESSONS

Honesty about what was difficult.

Despite real and meaningful achievements, the initial signature target was not reached. Looking back on an intense year of campaigning, several factors, both external and internal, help explain why, and offer lessons that will shape what comes next.

The most significant external obstacle was the nature of the subject itself. Psychedelic therapies remain largely unknown to the general public across much of Europe, and where they are known, stigma is still powerful. This created a dual challenge: the campaign had to **simultaneously inform, counter misconceptions, and mobilise**, which is a much heavier lift **than a campaign built around a topic already present in public consciousness**.

The same stigma made it difficult to bring **public figures and politicians on board**. Many who were privately sympathetic were not yet ready to associate their name publicly with psychedelics. A reality that limited the campaign's visibility at key moments, particularly in countries where media coverage was sparse.

Stigma & public awareness

The campaign had to simultaneously inform, counter misconceptions, and mobilise — a much heavier lift than a campaign on a familiar topic.

Shadow banning

Content related to psychedelics is routinely deprioritised by Meta's algorithms, limiting organic reach regardless of content quality.

Political risk

Many figures were privately sympathetic but not yet ready to publicly associate their name with psychedelics.

The ECI mechanism

The tool remains relatively unknown. Several countries require personal ID to sign, deterring people from associating their identity with controlled substances.

Volunteer engagement

Maintaining active engagement over twelve months proved difficult, leading at times to uneven distribution of tasks.

Budget constraints

Fundraising began later than it should have, limiting paid visibility compared to initiatives that reached the million-signature threshold.

09 — CHALLENGES & LESSONS

Operating on social media added another layer of difficulty. Content related to psychedelics is routinely **flagged and deprioritised by Meta's algorithms, significantly limiting organic reach** regardless of the quality of the content produced. This shadow-banning effect was a persistent obstacle throughout the year, and one that no amount of creative workaround could fully resolve.

The European Citizens' Initiative mechanism itself also presented challenges. As a democratic tool, it remains relatively unknown to most European citizens, meaning **the campaign had to explain both the means and the end simultaneously**.

Converting awareness of the cause into actual signatures required navigating a collection system that many found burdensome, and which raised legitimate concerns: several countries require signatories to provide personal identification, which deterred people from associating their identity with a topic linked to controlled substances. Technical issues compounded this and several hundred signatures were lost due to platform errors beyond our control.

Ultimately, these challenges are part of learning by doing. In the truest sense.

And there is a beauty in that too.

On the internal side, the campaign faced challenges common to volunteer-driven organisations, but worth naming honestly.

Maintaining active volunteer engagement over twelve months proved difficult, particularly during periods when signature numbers were slow and media outreach yielded little visible return. This led at times to **uneven distribution of tasks** and a **reliance on a small core of highly committed individuals**.

Onboarding processes were not always as structured as they needed to be, and the tools used for communication and file-sharing were not consistently applied, which means **information was sometimes lost**, and coordination suffered as a result.

Finally, fundraising began later than it should have. The combination of limited financial resources and insufficient dedicated capacity to develop them meant that PsychedeliCare **operated with a significantly smaller budget** than initiatives that have reached the million-signature threshold.

This constrained what was possible in terms of paid visibility, professional support, and sustained outreach and it is a lesson the organisation carries forward with clear intent to address it.

Ultimately, these challenges and lessons are part of what it means to build something from the ground up: learning by doing, in the truest sense. And there is a beauty in that too. Today, they serve above all as a compass for what comes next: understanding what did not work, what needs to improve, and equally, what is worth keeping and building on.

10 — FINANCIAL SNAPSHOT

Considerable reach. With available means.

The generous support of our donors and funders made it possible to bring our ideas to life, by equipping volunteers with communication materials, forging high-impact partnerships, and ensuring PsychedeliCare's presence across Europe.

€73,446 Total income Two grants + individual donations	€61,075 Total expenditure Full campaign period	€12,372 Balance carried forward Into the next phase
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How funds were used:

Communication	€37,468
Coordination	€14,400
Events	€5,685
Travel & expenses	€1,871
Operations	€1,641

Within the communication budget: €24,477 in content creator partnerships · €6,852 in materials for national teams · €4,390 in Meta advertising campaigns



Signing booth, Italy



Holomind Conference, Poland

11 — WHAT'S NEXT

The movement **continues.**

Looking back, a great deal was accomplished, driven above all by the energy and commitment of volunteers. There was something unique about this initiative: **an imperfect but genuine democratic and civic experience**, one that set in motion a remarkable number of actors across Europe and built something that did not exist before.

And yet a clear reality emerged. We did not reach our signature target, and we remain far from our founding goal: safe, effective, and affordable access to psychedelic care for every European citizen who needs it.

The core problem has not gone away. There is a systemic failure to align public understanding, political decision-making, and mental health policy with the best available scientific evidence, a disconnect that leaves mental health systems unable to integrate promising treatments, and millions of Europeans without access to potentially transformative care, accurate information, or responsible pathways for engagement.

This reality calls for **the movement to continue** with a renewed and deepened vision, mission, and set of activities, and with a structure and governance that reflects our deeply grassroots identity.

One thing the campaign made clear is that there is no single model for psychedelic care. During the initiative, our focus on clinical and medical use was deliberate: it represented the most common ground among European stakeholders, and the most legible framing for EU institutions. But we are convinced that multiple models of psychedelic care can coexist, be developed, and be implemented across Europe.

PsychedeliCare aspires to carry a broader and more nuanced vision of the psychedelic ecosystem, recognizing that there is no one-size-fits-all solution, and that lived experience must remain at the heart of every approach.

This is the vision that will guide PsychedeliCare going forward, a movement committed to inclusivity, to amplifying the voices of citizens and partner organisations, and to creating space for debate, nuance, and the coexistence of approaches:

“A Europe where psychedelic care is integrated into society, grounded in human rights, scientific evidence, and collective wellbeing; where cultural practices are recognised, and people are informed about the responsible use and therapeutic potential of psychedelics.”

11 — WHAT'S NEXT

The organisation being built to carry this vision is itself an expression of it. PsychedeliCare is in the process of adopting a governance model rooted in Teal principles and sociocratic practices, an approach that distributes authority across self-organizing circles, replaces top-down hierarchy with collective intelligence, and treats the organisation as a living system capable of evolving with its members and its context.

The idea is simple but radical: the way we organise ourselves should reflect the world we are trying to build.

Even before the campaign closed, a transition board was formed to begin shaping what comes after the ECI. Foundational steps have already been taken: the adoption of our manifesto, the implementation of new governance structures, and the development of several anchor projects.

What lies ahead is substantial. But it is with renewed energy and motivation, new ideas, new ways of organizing, and a deep commitment to inclusivity, that we will together build the future of psychedelic care in Europe.

Let's care together.



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